

Grad Cafe SQL Query Results

Interpretation note: for the question asking how many entries are from 2026, this report interprets 2026 as the application term/start term containing 2026, not the date the Grad Cafe row was added.

1. How many entries applied for Fall 2026?

Answer: 31471

Query used: `SELECT COUNT(*) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term = 'Fall 2026';`

Why this query: Counts every applicant row whose start term is exactly Fall 2026.

2. What percentage of entries are international students?

Answer: 46.58

Query used: `SELECT ROUND( 100.0 * COUNT(*) FILTER ( WHERE us_or_international NOT IN ('American', 'Other') ) / NULLIF(COUNT(*), 0), 2 ) AS answer FROM applicants;`

Why this query: Divides entries not marked American or Other by the full table count.

3. What are the average GPA, GRE, GRE V, and GRE AW values?

Answer: GPA: 3.75, GRE Q: 165.81, GRE V: 160.41, GRE AW: 4.33

Query used: `SELECT ROUND(AVG(gpa) FILTER (WHERE gpa BETWEEN 0 AND 4.33)::numeric, 2) AS avg_gpa, ROUND(AVG(gre) FILTER (WHERE gre BETWEEN 130 AND 170)::numeric, 2) AS avg_gre, ROUND(AVG(gre_v) FILTER (WHERE gre_v BETWEEN 130 AND 170)::numeric, 2) AS avg_gre_v, ROUND(AVG(gre_aw) FILTER (WHERE gre_aw BETWEEN 0 AND 6)::numeric, 2) AS avg_gre_aw FROM applicants;`

Why this query: Averages only provided values that fall on the expected reporting scales: GPA 0-4.33, GRE Quant and Verbal 130-170, and GRE Analytical Writing 0-6.

4. What is the average GPA of American students in Fall 2026?

Answer: 3.78

Query used: `SELECT ROUND(AVG(gpa)::numeric, 2) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term = 'Fall 2026' AND us_or_international = 'American';`

Why this query: Filters to American Fall 2026 entries and averages non-missing GPA values.

5. What percent of Fall 2026 entries are acceptances?

Answer: 37.09

Query used: `SELECT ROUND( 100.0 * COUNT(*) FILTER (WHERE status = 'Accepted') / NULLIF(COUNT(*), 0), 2 ) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term = 'Fall 2026';`

Why this query: Computes the accepted share among Fall 2026 entries.

6. What is the average GPA of accepted Fall 2026 applicants?

Answer: 3.76

Query used: `SELECT ROUND(AVG(gpa)::numeric, 2) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term = 'Fall 2026' AND status = 'Accepted';`

Why this query: Filters to accepted Fall 2026 entries and averages available GPAs.

7. How many entries applied to JHU for a master's degree in Computer Science?

Answer: 18

Query used: `SELECT COUNT(*) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE degree ILIKE 'Masters' AND program ILIKE '%Computer Science%' AND ( program ILIKE '%Johns Hopkins%' OR program ILIKE '%JHU%' );`

Why this query: Uses the downloaded program string to match JHU or Johns Hopkins, Computer Science, and Masters.

8. How many acceptances with a 2026 application term applied to Georgetown, MIT, Stanford, or Carnegie Mellon for a CS PhD?

Answer: 28

Query used: `SELECT COUNT(*) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term ILIKE '%2026%' AND status = 'Accepted' AND degree ILIKE 'PhD' AND program ILIKE '%Computer Science%' AND (program ILIKE '%Georgetown University%' OR program ILIKE '%MIT%' OR program ILIKE '%Massachusetts Institute of Technology%' OR program ILIKE '%Stanford University%' OR program ILIKE '%Carnegie Mellon University%');`

Why this query: Uses downloaded fields to count accepted CS PhD entries at the requested universities. Here, 'from 2026' is interpreted as rows whose application term contains 2026.

9. Does question 8 change when using LLM generated fields?

Answer: Downloaded fields: 28; LLM fields: 28; result did not change.

Query used: WITH downloaded_fields AS (SELECT COUNT(*) AS count FROM applicants WHERE term ILIKE '%2026%' AND status = 'Accepted' AND degree ILIKE 'PhD' AND program ILIKE '%Computer Science%' AND (program ILIKE '%Georgetown University%' OR program ILIKE '%MIT%' OR program ILIKE '%Massachusetts Institute of Technology%' OR program ILIKE '%Stanford University%' OR program ILIKE '%Carnegie Mellon University%')), llm_fields AS (SELECT COUNT(*) AS count FROM applicants WHERE term ILIKE '%2026%' AND status = 'Accepted' AND degree ILIKE 'PhD' AND llm_generated_program ILIKE '%Computer Science%' AND (llm_generated_university ILIKE '%Georgetown University%' OR llm_generated_university ILIKE '%MIT%' OR llm_generated_university ILIKE '%Massachusetts Institute of Technology%' OR llm_generated_university ILIKE '%Stanford University%' OR llm_generated_university ILIKE '%Carnegie Mellon University%')) SELECT downloaded_fields.count AS downloaded_count, llm_fields.count AS llm_count, downloaded_fields.count <> llm_fields.count AS changed FROM downloaded_fields, llm_fields;

Why this query: Compares the downloaded-field count from question 8 with the same 2026-term count using standardized LLM program and university fields.

10. Original question: What percentage of entries include applicant comments?

Answer: 47.69

Query used: SELECT ROUND(100.0 * COUNT(*) FILTER (WHERE comments IS NOT NULL AND LENGTH(TRIM(comments)) > 0) / NULLIF(COUNT(*), 0), 2) AS answer FROM applicants;

Why this query: Measures how often self-submitted rows include non-empty comments.

11. Original question: What are the most common applicant statuses?

Answer: Rejected: 21651; Accepted: 19507; Waitlisted: 4835; Interview: 4048

Query used: SELECT status, COUNT(*) AS count FROM applicants GROUP BY status ORDER BY count DESC, status LIMIT 5;

Why this query: Groups entries by decision status and returns the five most frequent statuses.